

FIRST 120 DAYS • DATA & AI ENABLEMENT LEAD

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ENTRY PRINCIPLE

Earn the right to scale.

Start with one decision-critical slice. Make its data, ownership, authority, workflow, and evidence visible. Then compound the pattern.

Working assumptions

The end client, systems landscape, operating model, and regulatory context are confidential. This plan is intentionally adaptable and begins with discovery rather than imposing a preselected architecture.

DAYS 1-30 • LISTEN AND MAP

Establish operating reality

- Meet executive sponsors, business leaders, data/IT/security/legal, users, and key vendors.
- Inventory reporting, CRM, document, workflow, integration, analytics, and AI-tool landscape.
- Map definitions, ownership, access, quality, lineage, current workarounds, and known risks.
- Observe high-friction work directly; establish baseline measures and decision consequences.
- Select one bounded workflow with value, sponsor ownership, usable data, and learnable risk.

Outputs: system and stakeholder map; data/AI risk register; opportunity portfolio; first-workflow charter.

DAYS 31-60 • ALIGN AND BOUND

Create a trusted slice

- Name data owners and reconcile canonical definitions for the selected workflow.
- Define source, transformation, quality thresholds, lineage, access, retention, and exceptions.
- Clarify target architecture and vendor responsibilities without overbuilding the first use case.
- Define AI role, prohibited actions, human decision rights, review points, and escalation.
- Agree outcome, adoption, risk, and learning measures before implementation.

Outputs: trusted data slice; authority/guardrail contract; architecture decision; pilot scorecard.

FIRST-60-DAY LEADERSHIP CADENCE

Cadence	Purpose	Participants
Weekly workflow review	Resolve definitions, ownership, exceptions, and user friction	Workflow owner, data steward, users, technical lead
Biweekly architecture/vendor review	Make build/buy/connect decisions and prevent dependency	IT/data/security, vendors, enablement lead
Monthly executive portfolio review	Prioritize, fund, hold, stop, and remove barriers	Sponsor and business leaders

DAY-30 DECISION GATE

Proceed only when the first workflow has an accountable business owner, a decision or outcome worth improving, accessible data with visible gaps, an acceptable risk boundary, and enough user participation to learn from real work.

DAYS 61-90 • EMBED AND PROVE

Put one intervention into real work

- Build or coordinate the smallest useful AI-assisted intervention using the trusted data slice.
- Integrate at the actual workflow decision point rather than creating a separate demo destination.
- Train users on both the new action and the reason for human review or escalation.
- Instrument adoption, workflow outcome, data quality, exception behavior, and user feedback.
- Run short learning cycles; correct the workflow, data, prompt, control, or ownership as evidence requires.

Outputs: production-bounded pilot; user standard work; support/escalation path; evidence readout.

DAYS 91-120 • STANDARDIZE AND SCALE

Turn one win into capability

- Decide scale, revise, hold, or retire based on evidence - not sponsorship enthusiasm.
- Package reusable definitions, connectors, controls, training, evaluation, and decision records.
- Establish AI tool standards, approved patterns, exception paths, and portfolio governance.
- Create vendor scorecard and knowledge-transfer requirements; identify internal capability gaps.
- Sequence the next 2-3 workflow slices by value, readiness, ownership, risk, and reuse.

Outputs: reusable enablement package; portfolio roadmap; vendor operating model; executive scorecard.

120-DAY SCORECARD

Dimension	Question at day 120	Evidence expected
Trust	Does the first workflow have named, usable, governed data?	Owners, definitions, lineage, quality and access rules
Use	Is the intervention retained in normal work?	Repeat behavior and adoption feedback
Flow	Did the work improve?	Baseline versus observed cycle, error, rework, or service
Control	Are authority and exceptions operational?	Review, escalation, incident/exception records
Capability	Can the firm repeat the pattern without starting over?	Reusable assets, standards, ownership, roadmap

EXPLICIT NON-GOALS

Do not

Launch a broad AI tool campaign before identifying workflow ownership and evidence.

Do not

Build an enterprise data model detached from the decisions and work it must improve.

Do not

Let vendors become the only people who understand the architecture or operating logic.

Do not

Count access, licenses, demos, or training attendance as value realization.

SCALE CRITERIA

Scale when	Repair or hold when
Data ownership and quality are repeatable; users retain the behavior; workflow benefit and control evidence are credible; reusable assets reduce the cost of the next slice.	Definitions remain disputed; human authority is vague; usage depends on champions manually rescuing the process; benefit cannot be separated from novelty; vendor knowledge is not transferable.

EARLY RISK REGISTER

Risk	Leading indicator	Response
Platform-first overreach	Architecture discussion without a workflow owner or baseline	Anchor each platform decision to a bounded business slice
Definition conflict	Reports disagree and no owner can resolve meaning	Escalate canonical definition and stewardship decision
Shadow AI	Unapproved data enters tools or outputs guide decisions without review	Publish useful approved patterns and practical exception paths
Vendor dependence	Internal team cannot explain design, controls, or runbook	Require decision records, paired delivery, documentation, and transfer
Adoption theater	Training attendance high; repeat workflow use low	Observe work, simplify intervention, address incentives and burden
Measurement gap	No baseline or outcome owner before pilot	Hold launch until evidence and ownership are agreed

DECISIONS TO CLARIFY DURING DISCOVERY

1. Expected balance of hands-on platform engineering versus architecture, vendor, and business ownership.
2. Current cloud, data warehouse/lake, BI, CRM, document, identity, and AI-tool environment.
3. Regulated data classes, privacy obligations, model-risk requirements, and acceptable-use boundaries.
4. Executive sponsor, data/IT reporting relationships, and decision rights for standards and funding.
5. Known data-domain conflicts and the first workflow leadership considers strategically important.
6. Available internal data engineering, security, architecture, change, and training capacity.

FIRST LEADERSHIP CONVERSATION

Ask

Which workflow or data domain currently creates the most consequential uncertainty, rework, risk, or delay?

Clarify

What must this leader personally build, what should internal teams own, and where should vendors accelerate?

DAY-120 EXECUTIVE READOUT

WHAT LEADERSHIP SHOULD BE ABLE TO SEE

ONE WORKFLOW IS
TRUSTED,
BOUNDED,
ADOPTED,
MEASURED - AND
HAS LEFT A
REUSABLE
OPERATING
PATTERN BEHIND.